

Addressing queries

Firstly, you should establish a cordial relationship with your buyer as soon as they place an order. Sometimes, buyers will establish contact with you before placing an order. You should provide answers via email or through the online message service of the relevant e-commerce retailer. You should note that Amazon and eBay won't allow sellers to contact buyers directly via email. The queries and issues should be addressed only via the online medium. Flipkart will not allow buyers to contact sellers before purchase. Hence, all queries will be routed through their own internal customer service team. Once the product has been delivered to the customer, sellers are not normally responsible for addressing queries. It is the responsibility of the buyer to contact the manufacturer. For example, if Mr. Nathan purchases an LG television via Flipkart, then he should contact LG's toll-free number for installation and service. To retain customers, sellers registered with Flipkart and Amazon can go a level higher and directly contact the manufacturer and provide the relevant information to the customer. The local service centre or technician will establish contact with the buyer to facilitate the installation process.

Retaining customers

As a seller in the crowded online marketplace, retaining buyers is a challenge. You have to be proactive and answer queries quickly. Ideally, you should establish a presence on Facebook, Twitter and Instagram instead of the traditional telephone support. If you are selling directly, you can offer free gifts with every product. You can also provide buyers with a coupon code to enable them to avail a discount on their next purchase. Amazon offers cashback for every order up to a certain limit for purchases made during the Great Indian Shopping Festival. The intention of this scheme is to force buyers to shop on their platform on a recurring basis, which will ultimately benefit sellers. Amazon also allows buyers to gift wrap items during the checkout process.

If a customer contacts you via email or phone, responding within one hour is optimal. The key to success is accessibility. You should not make false promises regarding a product. Disclose as much information regarding features and specifications. Otherwise, you will end up landing in consumer courts and forums. The best way to retain old customers is to under promise things and delivering in an improved manner. With huge competition in the online segment, it is vital to establish trust with your customers. Suppose